

position of your head, neck, and shoulders in relation to the rest of your body (see pp184–185), and that is the first step on the road to correction.

Dance as an aerobic activity

Unfortunately, because of the way a dance class is usually structured, dance is not considered to be an aerobic activity. Normally, a ballet teacher, for example, will stop the class each time he or she wants to show a sequence at the barre or when teaching floor work. True aerobic activity must be continuous, so this type of dance class will not offer you an aerobic workout.

My four workouts give you the best of both worlds: a combination of aerobics with dance. And they can be enjoyed in optimal time—just 15 minutes! In addition, each one can be tailored to beginner, intermediate, or advanced levels. You don't have to do them in a specific order: just start with your favorite dance style.

Why these dance styles?

In my choice of dance styles for this project, I have tried to reflect something of the vast range of popular dance genres. I have chosen from both mainstream popular dance culture and from dance as a classical art form. As you learn a few moves from classical ballet, I hope you will gain a greater understanding and appreciation of that style of dance. The tone and movements of the jazz workout are reminiscent of Bob Fosse and the Broadway musical. Salsa, with its gentle rolling of the hips, has a sultry Latin-American mood, while the street workout has an earthy, grounded feel. One dance genre might appeal to you more than another, but trying them all can be lots of fun.

The movements are really easy to pick up. Always learn the feet first, then add the arms and, when you are feeling confident, the shoulders and hips. Don't forget to have fun and to add your own personal style to the steps.

Jazz enhances coordination, balance, and muscle tone through powerful, sharp-angled movements.



Street improves rhythm and coordination and encourages diversity of movement.

